

Telepathy: Let There be Empathy!



What does Empathy, powered by the Telepathy framework, have in its bag for us? Well, besides audio/video chat, there's geo-location and collaboration, with more coming up.

One of the primary issues faced by new Linux users is the lack of an efficient program for audio/video conferencing along with good integration with other desktop applications. This is something that Mac OSX has done well, with its iChat program. While programs exist for multi-protocol text chat on Linux, until recently we did not have a nice solution for audio/video chat and collaboration. The solution to all these problems requires a powerful communications framework, which is exactly what Telepathy aims to be. Telepathy is as revolutionary a communications application as GStreamer was among media applications.

What's this Telepathy?

The Telepathy project was started in 2005 by a company called Collabora Ltd. It is basically a real-time communications framework and uses the DBus messaging system. It was designed with instant messaging and VoIP-like applications in mind. What makes it really powerful is that it was designed from the start to be highly modular and extensible. It provides a standardised interface, making it easier to implement new features and support new protocols. This also results in code that is easy to maintain and that is portable. Hence, Telepathy can be used on various hardware devices running a variety of software platforms. It is because